



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2024 Version B for STA 235H - DATA SCI FOR BUSN APPS: HON (05220) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2024**

Courses Audience: **44**

Responses Received: **44**

Response Ratio: **100%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

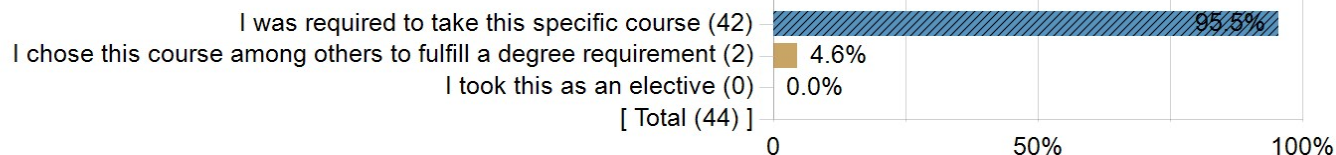
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

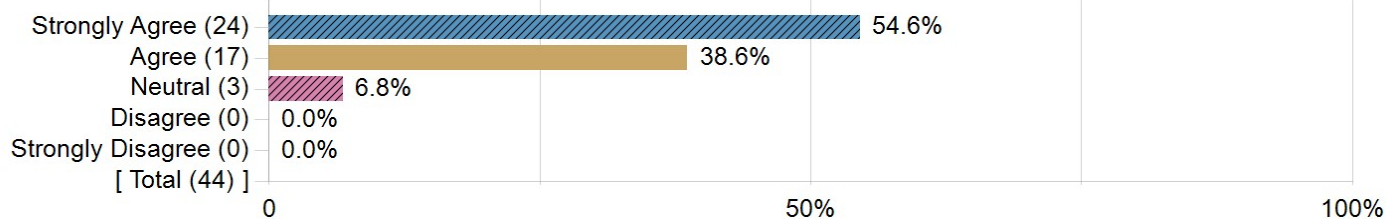
Creation Date: **Thursday, January 23, 2025**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



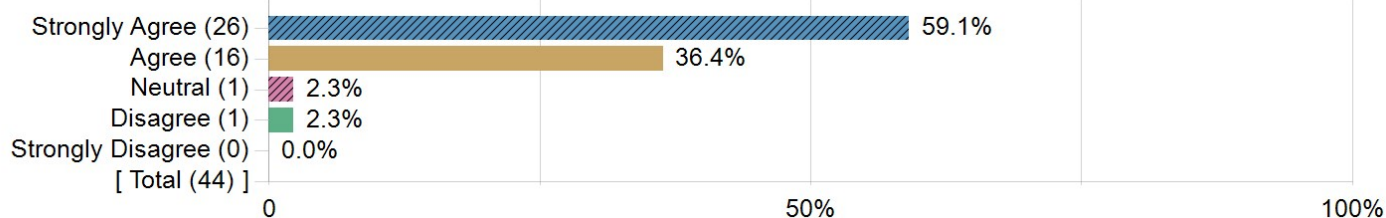
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.48

The course was well organized.



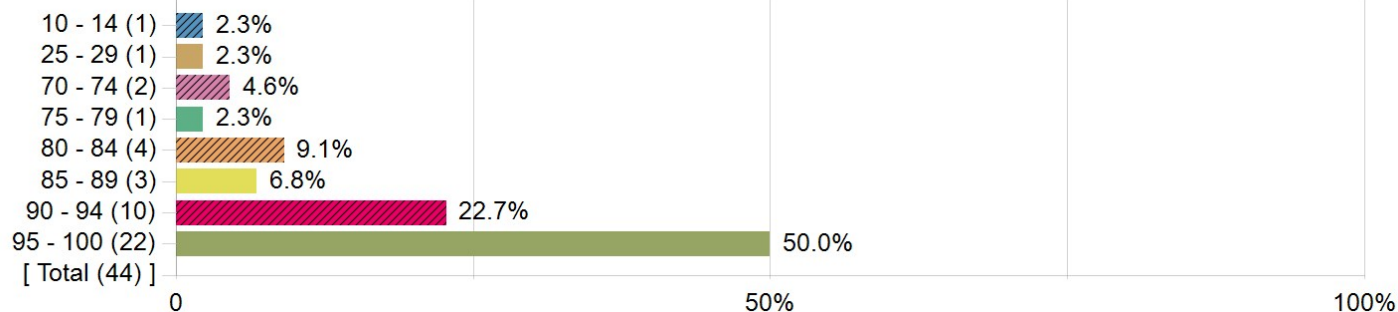
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.52

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



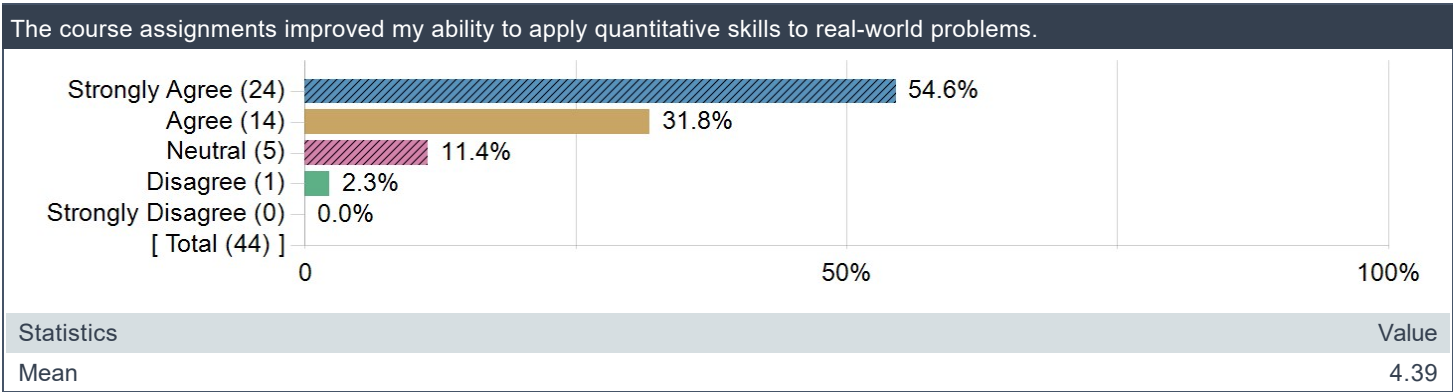
Statistics

Value

Mean

88.55

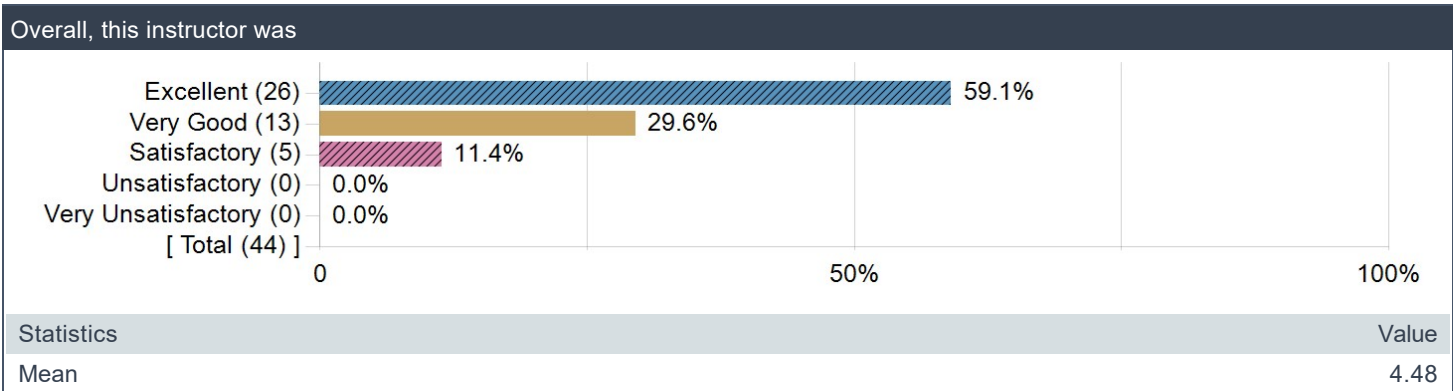
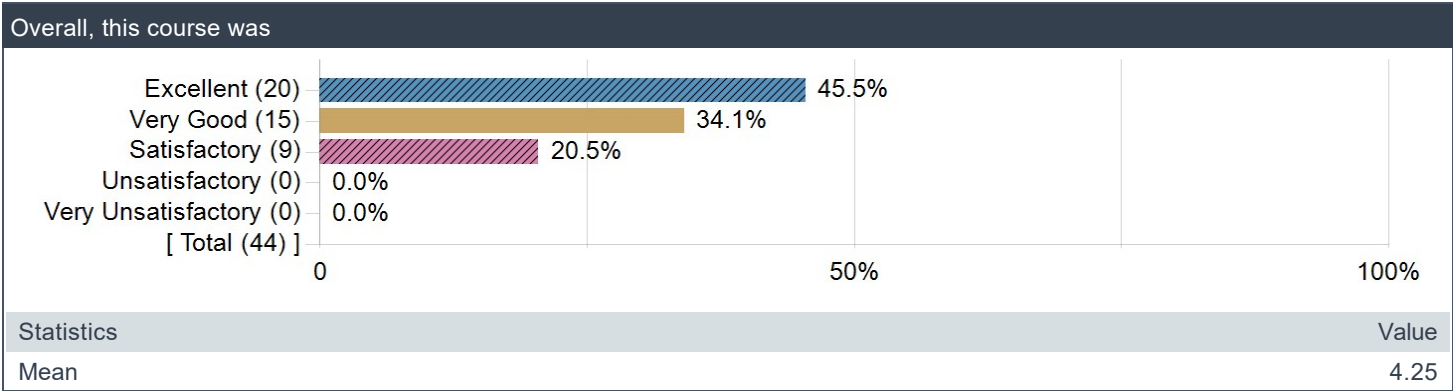
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



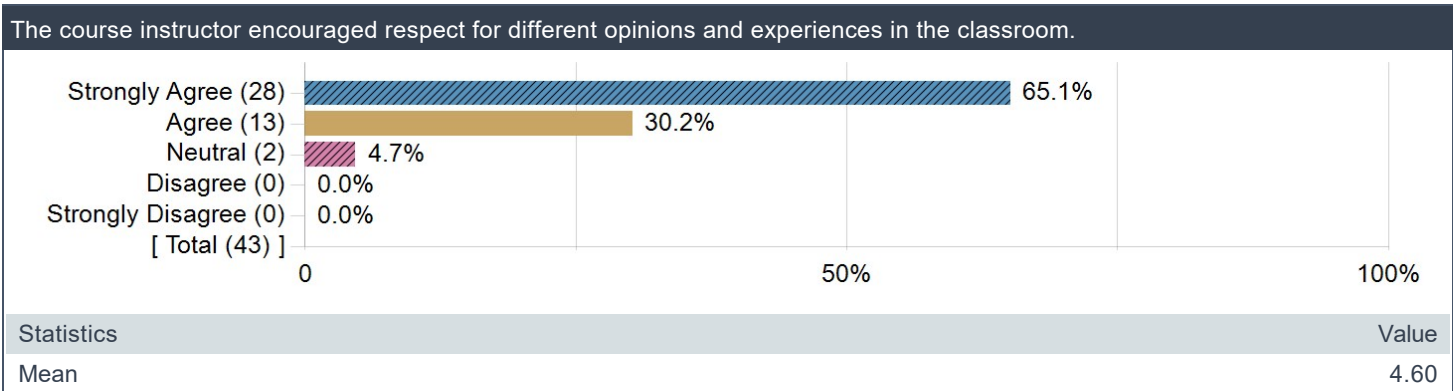
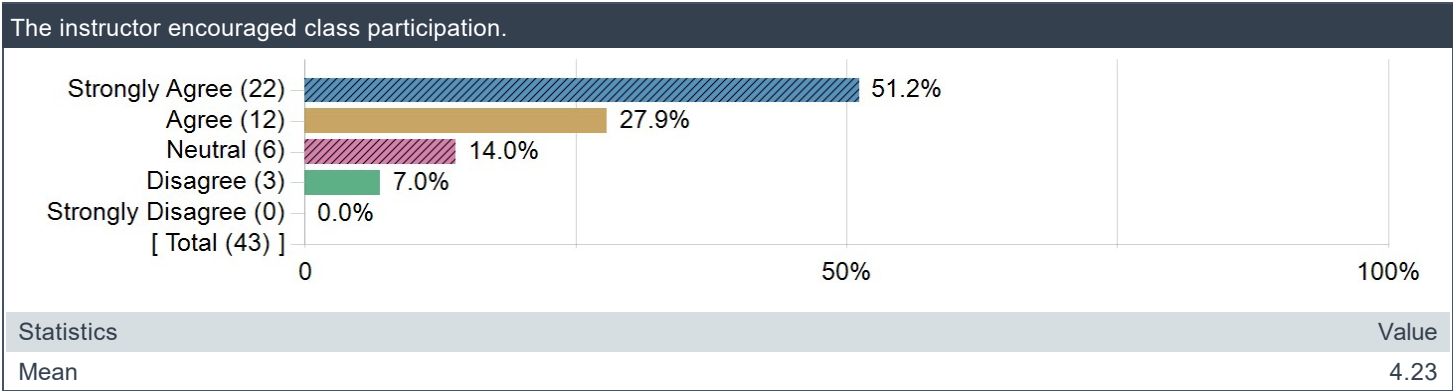
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	59.1%	31.8%	6.8%	2.3%	0.0%	44	4.48
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	72.7%	22.7%	4.5%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.68
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	52.3%	36.4%	9.1%	2.3%	0.0%	44	4.39
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	43.2%	20.5%	27.3%	6.8%	2.3%	44	3.95
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	56.8%	27.3%	15.9%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.41

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Having recorded lectures gave me the opportunity to look back on concepts I didn't understand in class
Notes and in class code being posted online to allow for efficient catching up.
Slideshows were very thorough and extremely helpful.
the manner class was taught, having multiple homework attempts and just professor being open to questions
The class was thorough, but it was hard to translate it to the real world and the class assignments.
Practice homeworks and KCs
I found the HWs/KCs to be the most helpful.
– KC and end-of-class assignments are very effective in distilling core ideas from lectures – Practice exam materials were EXTREMELY helpful for midterm exam (I assume will be similar for final exam), easily the most helpful resource for the midterm exam
The slideshows and notes were very helpful
Class slides and practice exams were the most helpful things to my learning.
Super helpful teacher during office hours and in class! His presentations and teaching style helped me understand the content very well and his approach weaving in coding and conceptuals gave me a deeper understanding of not only the statistics content but also its application.
The knowledge checks and class assignments at the end of class really helped me learn and course correct myself if I didn't understand concepts.
The homeworks, KCs, and in-class checks were great.
Writing the R script in class together
I loved how organized and detailed the slides were – they made the content easily digestible but also easy to refresh before exams.
the lectures and r script
A lot of practice
KCs
clear powerpoints
The knowledge checks and homework were very useful for practice
The KCs were helpful.
Interactively coding in class.
Flexibility in learning the material both in class and through recorded lectures as well as a funny and engaging professor,
I loved how we walked through scripts together while going through slideshows and having him take his time for each topic.
The knowledge checks were helpful.
KC's
HWs
Great explanations during class
Understands course content very well to answer questions.
KC's and Homeworks
I enjoyed the examples in class.
Practice assignments and opening up homework scripts
Amazing professor!!!
Knowledge Checks helped ensure I understood the content well after the lectures.
The slideshows and R-scripts given were helpful for me to relearn topics I The KC's and Homeworks were great opportunities to apply my learning and reinforce my understanding of the content.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
Having heavy content for 2 hours straight once a week was a little draining and hard to comprehend.
The long class time made it hard to pay attention.
the material was difficult for me
Keeping up with concepts in class
I found it challenging that we didn't do more practice in-class (we instead worked through problems together), and I feel like I could've had a more active learning experience in that sense.
– Course lectures are very long/uninterrupted and not much interaction with the class if at all. I found it very difficult to follow along and focus fully even on concepts that I was especially concerned with. Perhaps the class can take a more interactive format or you can provide shorter resources to look through start of class (especially since a large portion of the course was review from STA301H) that we would then not need to cover as in-depth in class and more interactive elements of the class could apply here. I also think this class just shouldn't be a 2 credit hour based on the amount of content covered and could be changed to a 1 credit hour class but that likely isn't possible
I found the lectures to be a little difficult to follow because they were fairly long and included a lot of witching back and forth between the slides and the R script.
I found paying attention to the 2 hour long lectures to be the most challenging thing, especially since the topic didn't take that long to learn. I think more practice problems or independent working time in each class could have been helpful.
I found some of the homeworks challenging but there was a lot of support from TAs and professor office hours and everything else was very manageable.
I found odds to be most challenging because it was a concept that had many different ways to be interpreted. One thing to help further students could be posting extra help videos or practice problems.
The 2 hours lectures were too long so it was hard to pay-attention and comprehend the information.
Paying attention to a 2 hour long lecture was very difficult, so breaking it up into more sections with more breaks and more interactive work could be helpful
N/A
the HW bc they were very detailed. maybe go over hw when due date is over
Nothing! He's a great professor
miskeyed assignments made learning and clarity difficult
I thought the most challenging part of the course was understanding some of the content featured in the second half of the semester. I think it was challenging simply due to the subject matter being inherently difficult. It also seemed to build significantly on skills we learned in a previous course. Perhaps one way the challenge could be made easier would be in-class reviews of key functions learned in STA 301H when they are relevant to specific lectures (e.g. prop table).
The course was hard to keep up with since it was one two hour class.
Staying focused for 2 hours.
I feel like the conceptual stuff during the second half of the year wasn't taught as effectively, and I wish we would cover more examples to talk about them. Especially with experiments and RCT's, more examples would help.
Some of the homeworks were inordinately long.
Tests
N/A
Nothing comes to mind, professor did great!
Really quite and sometimes disengaged from class.
Studying for the exams, wish there was more than just one practice exam!
n/a
Most challenging aspect — focusing in class for 2 hours straight. Split up the class into 2 one hour sessions for easier comprehension
Last exam was a little harder than expected
The exam difficulty and homework difficulty seemed different (partially since we had more attempts on homework). If the homeworks were a little more constrained (time limit and limited attempts), it would be easier to prepare for the pacing of the exam.
Certain concepts were difficult to grasp, so maybe uploading short videos on specific topics could be beneficial.

